



TD SYNnex



/ Revolution



CISCO 360 PARTNER PROGRAM

Managed Services Practice Maturity

Your TD SYNnex roadmap to MS practice recognition.

The managed services opportunity is growing exponentially. Today's customers are shifting from buying products to demanding outcomes. By 2027, 46% of Cisco products will be sold with a managed service, driven by customer demand for outcome-based solutions. This **TD SYNnex** guide walks you through the three managed services (MS) practice maturity levels — **Basic**, **Intermediate**, and **Expert** — and shows exactly what you need to qualify, score, and grow your partner value index.

Turn the page to get started or select a tab to jump to that section.

PROGRAM
OVERVIEW

BASIC

INTERMEDIATE

EXPERT

THE TD SYNnex
ADVANTAGE

OVERVIEW

MS Practice Maturity

The Cisco-based **Managed Services Practice Maturity (MSPM) Framework** is an integral part of the Cisco 360 Partner Program and is designed to evaluate a partner's ability to deliver scalable, repeatable, and customer-centric managed services. As you expand and mature your managed services practice, your value index increases, unlocking more benefits.

This framework assesses the partner's operating model maturity across critical domains such as **Service Portfolio Management, Operational Excellence, Automation & Tooling, Customer Success Management, and Security & Compliance.**

Per Cisco: "Our customers are telling us loud and clear that managed services are increasingly how they adopt transformative technology. And our partners are telling us that this business model is where they expect the biggest growth. That makes managed services critical to Cisco's future as well."

There are three levels for MS Practice Maturity, each with a set of requirements reflecting the sophistication of an organization's Cisco managed service. The intention of Practice Maturity is to recognize organizations that have invested in recurring revenue lifecycle practices that support customer value realization for services and software.

BASIC	INTERMEDIATE	EXPERT
5	7	10
Metric Value	Metric Value	Metric Value
Demonstrable managed services practice. Foundational services, developing operations, and early recurring revenue.	Established managed services practice. Expanding Cisco-powered services, documented processes, and growing adoption.	Optimized managed services practice. Advanced operations, multiple Cisco Powered Services, and scalable recurring revenue.
Desk Validation	Audit +1 Powered Service	Audit +3 Powered Services

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Cisco's Evaluation Approach

The Cisco-based Managed Services Practice Maturity assessment comprises a two-step process:

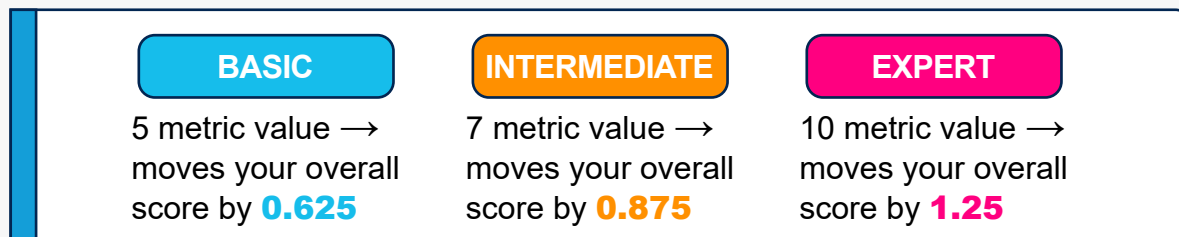


A holistic managed services practice is one where **business processes, tools, and teams** are fully aligned and integrated to support the entire managed services lifecycle from initial engagement through ongoing operations and continuous improvement. This end-to-end approach ensures **consistent service delivery, maximizes customer value**, and positions partners for **long-term success** in meeting evolving customer demands.

All partners that plan to have their MSPM recognized under the Cisco 360 Partner Program are expected to meet the specific level requirements via evidence for each control. Controls may consist of **documentation, demonstrations, tools** and **personnel**.

Why it Matters for Your Business

Managed Services Practice Maturity is **50% of the Foundational category** in each portfolio's Partner Value Index. These points determine partner titles, rebates, and benefits.



The higher your level of eligibility in MSPM, the more the discount increases.

Stack	Eligibility	Discount
MS Practice Maturity Level	MS Practice Maturity Expert + Cisco Powered Services	→
	MS Practice Maturity Intermediate + Cisco Powered Services	→
	MS Practice Maturity Basic	→

REQUIREMENTS

At a Glance

Cisco's Managed Services Practice Maturity Framework is a three-level design structured to meet partners where they are in their Cisco Managed Service journey. The program recognizes and validates a partner's overall managed service capabilities and operational excellence applied across portfolios. It incorporates widely recognized industry best-practices in IT service management and value-based reporting for optimal customer success.

REQUIREMENTS	BASIC	INTERMEDIATE	EXPERT
PERSONNEL			
MS Practice Lead	✓	✓	✓
MS Management: Sales Specialist	✓	✓	✓
MS Management: Product Management	—	✓	✓
Level 1-3 Support Staff	1	3	2
Sales, Marketing, and Billing Roles	—	—	✓
Executive Sponsor	—	—	✓
Customer Success and Renewals	—	—	2 CSMs, 1 RM
Personnel Certified with ITIL Foundation v.3 or higher	—	1	2

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REQUIREMENTS	BASIC	INTERMEDIATE	EXPERT
CISCO POWERED SERVICES			
Cisco Powered Services (CPS)	—	1	3, 1 strategic
DOCUMENTATION AND DEMONSTRATIONS			
Basic Questionnaire	✓	—	—
MSPM Assessment Documentation	—	✓	✓
MSPM Assessment Demonstrations	—	✓	✓
Cisco Powered Service General Requirements Documents	—	1	3
Cisco Powered Service Specialization Documents	—	1	3, 1 strategic
ASSESSMENT AND REVIEW			
Assessment Type	Desk review	Half day assessment	Full day assessment
Annual Checks	✓	✓	✓
Audit Cadence	—	3 years	3 years

CISCO

Powered Services

Cisco Powered Service Specializations are an achievement that validates partners' abilities to successfully build, provision, manage, and support managed services built on Cisco technology to deliver specific business outcomes.



Increased Partner Value Index

Unlock enhanced benefits with MSPM Expert and Intermediate level, which require Powered Services.

[Click for details.](#)

+0.75

Collab Portfolio Value Index

Directly contribute to the Capabilities metric in the Collaboration PVI, a 0.75 metric value.



Enhanced Benefits and Incentives

Be eligible to earn higher rebates, programmatic discounts, and differentiation for strategic offers.



Strong Market Differentiation

Demonstrate service excellence with the Cisco Powered Services logo and Partner Locator visibility.



Operational Excellence

Build validated delivery capabilities and demonstrate technical and operational excellence.



Programmatic Discount for MSP

Quote and sell with velocity and profitability, supporting upfront discounts for well-priced services.

[Click for details.](#)

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Assessment Requirements

Each Cisco Powered Service undergoes an objective review and validation process, including an independent third-party assessment, to ensure managed service capabilities and business outcomes are delivered.

The assessment includes two components: the General Requirements and the Service-specific Requirements. For all the details, view the [Cisco Powered Service Assessment Prep Guide](#) on SalesConnect.

General Requirements

Foundational managed services criteria that apply to every Cisco Powered Service.

Covers core capabilities such as operational processes, service documentation, customer experience expectations, and overall service readiness.

Service-Specific Requirements

Requirements tailored to the specific Cisco Powered Service being pursued.

Validates the partner's ability to deliver, operate, and support the technology and use cases unique to that offer (e.g., AI Infrastructure, Meeting Rooms).

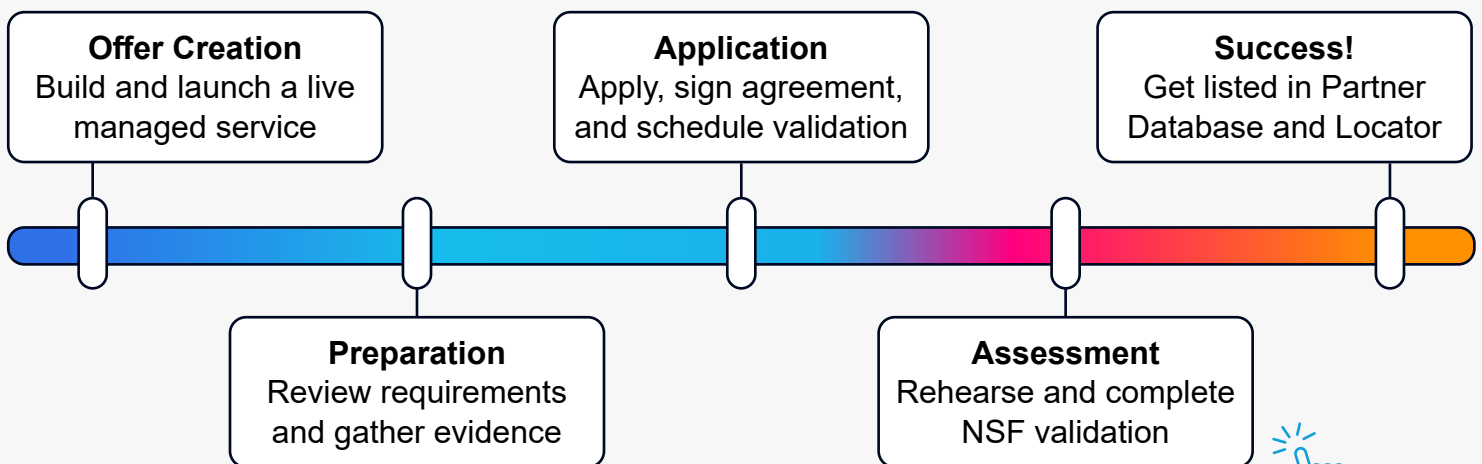


Select to view requirements.

The Process

The assessment process is handled by the third party NSF Consulting, which offers [readiness courses](#). Powered Service Assessments cost \$3,000 per day, but a partner can assess for up to three Powered Services in one day.

Earning a Cisco Powered Services designation follows a five-phase process, from building a live managed service offer to final validation and partner recognition.



Select each step for more details.



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Basic

DOCUMENT REVIEW

The Basic level is the entry for partners who are either in the early stage of building their managed services practice or new to the Cisco 360 Partner Program. Partners' applications are reviewed by Cisco to ensure they meet the requirements of this level.

5

Metric Value

+0.625

to overall PVI score

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Assessment Requirements for Basic Level

The Basic MSPM application consists of a detailed questionnaire. Screenshots or supporting documents can be uploaded to validate your processes. The application captures three main areas.

Partner & Contact Information

- Company details
- Primary MSP and program contacts

Managed Services Practice Information

You'll describe your Cisco-based managed service, including:

- Service name and description
- Market segments served
- Geographic availability
- Packaging and recurring billing model

Service Delivery & Operations

The questionnaire walks through how you operate your service:

- Customer onboarding and offboarding
- Monitoring and incident management
- Ticketing tools and service hours
- SLAs and service objectives
- Disaster recovery and business continuity

MSPM BASIC QUESTIONNAIRE



The Process

1

Download the [questionnaire](#) from SalesConnect.

2

Contact mspm-basic@cisco.com for support, if needed.

3

Apply at www.cisco.com/go/pma.



Intermediate

3 YEAR AUDIT • 1 POWERED SERVICE

The Intermediate level is intended for partners who have a mature managed services practice. These partners demonstrate structured managed services delivery, operational oversight, and strong alignment with Cisco technology. At this level, partners are required to demonstrate clear governance mechanisms, repeatable methodologies, and a strong commitment to continuous improvement.

7

Metric Value

+0.875

to overall PVI score

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Assessment Requirements for Intermediate Level

The MSPM assessment is organized around the Land, Adopt, Expand, Renew (LAER) lifecycle, with an additional section for general practice requirements. The complete requirements, including description of control points and required evidence for each section, are available in the [Cisco Managed Services Practice Maturity Framework](#).

1.0 General

Assesses foundational readiness and governance for managed services.

2.0 Land

Assess capability to position, sell, and onboard managed services.

4.0 Expand

Assess processes driving upsell, cross-sell, and value growth.

3.0 Adopt

Assess delivery quality and customer success execution.

5.0 Renew

Assess retention, service evolution, and continuous improvement.



Select each section for more detail.

The Process

Intermediate MSPM requires two prerequisites: one Cisco Powered Services designation and one ITIL Foundation certification (version 3 or higher). Because both must be in place before the MSPM assessment begins, the path to Intermediate happens in two phases.

- **Prerequisite Phase:** Complete your ITIL Foundation certification, then apply for a Cisco Powered Service through the PMA tool and successfully complete the Powered Service Assessment.
- **MSPM Assessment Phase:** Apply for Intermediate MSPM in PMA and complete the assessment within 45 days of NSF contacting you to schedule it.
- **Readiness Courses:** NSF Consulting also offers assessment prep courses for both the Cisco Powered Service and MSPM assessments. Visit the [Cisco/NSF site](#) for details and fee schedules.

** Partners are able to submit a Powered Service application and MSPM application simultaneously, but must successfully pass the Powered Service Assessment prior to the MSPM Assessment.*



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Expert

3 YEAR AUDIT • 3 POWERED SERVICES

The Expert level represents the highest level of recognition for partners. It is aimed at partners with a highly mature and scalable managed services business that delivers consistent customer outcomes and drives innovation across Cisco solution areas.

10

Metric Value

+1.25

to overall PVI score

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Assessment Requirements for Expert Level

The MSPM assessment is organized around the Land, Adopt, Expand, Renew (LAER) lifecycle, with an additional section for general practice requirements. The complete requirements, including description of control points and required evidence for each section, are available in the [Cisco Managed Services Practice Maturity Framework](#).

1.0 General

Assesses foundational readiness and governance for managed services.

2.0 Land

Assess capability to position, sell, and onboard managed services.

4.0 Expand

Assess processes driving upsell, cross-sell, and value growth.

3.0 Adopt

Assess delivery quality and customer success execution.

5.0 Renew

Assess retention, service evolution, and continuous improvement.



Select each section for more detail.

The Process

Expert MSPM requires two prerequisites: three Cisco Powered Services designations and two ITIL Foundation certifications (version 3 or higher). Because both must be in place before the MSPM assessment begins, the path to Expert happens in two phases.

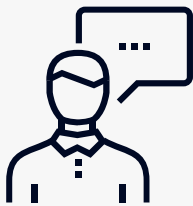
- **Prerequisite Phase:** Complete your two ITIL Foundation certifications, then apply for three Cisco Powered Services through the PMA tool and successfully complete the Powered Service Assessment. You may assess up to three Powered Services in one day.
- **MSPM Assessment Phase:** Apply for Expert MSPM in PMA and complete the assessment within 45 days of NSF contacting you to schedule it.
- **Readiness Courses:** NSF Consulting also offers assessment prep courses for both the Cisco Powered Service and MSPM assessments. Visit the [Cisco/NSF site](#) for details and fee schedules.

** Partners are able to submit a Powered Service application and MSPM application simultaneously, but must successfully pass the Powered Service Assessment prior to the MSPM Assessment.*

Power Your Cisco Partnership

The IT landscape is evolving—and so are the opportunities. As Cisco shifts toward a software-first, subscription-based model, partners need more than products—they need a strategy. That's where [TD SYNnex Revolution](#) comes in.

Revolution is a purpose-built team of Cisco experts dedicated to helping partners navigate the complexities of Recurring Revenue, Enterprise Agreements, Customer Experience and Operational Excellence. Revolution provides the tools, training, support and as-a-service options, to help you grow your Cisco practice, maximize profitability and deliver measurable value to your customers. These programs are designed to empower Cisco partners by providing a comprehensive suite of resources, including:

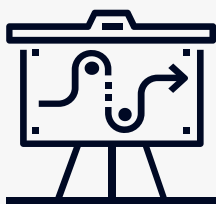


Consulting Services

Experts focused on best practices and strategies to enhance your Cisco partnership.

Training & Education

Specialized training sessions that improve partner capabilities, knowledge, and your PVI score!



Tools & Tactics

Resources designed to help partners streamline operations and maximize profitability.

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Unlock Your PVI Potential

[TD SYNEX Revolution](#) integrates seamlessly with the Cisco 360 Program, providing a holistic, end-to-end view of your Cisco lifecycle practice. From onboarding and adoption to expansion and renewal, we help you align with Cisco's most strategic initiatives and deliver value at every stage of the customer journey.

Your Cisco Partner Value Index (PVI) score unlocks greater opportunities, stronger discounts, and higher profitability. As your score increases, you gain access to expanded rebates, improved Cisco pricing, and enhanced incentives. TD SYNEX is committed to helping partners understand and improve their Cisco 360 Partner Program value index score potential.

What to expect when working with TD SYNEX:

- 1 Gap Analysis**
During this stage, TD SYNEX works with partners to fully understand their current Cisco business position and identify clear opportunities for growth.
- 2 Deep Dive**
Once initial gaps and goals are defined, our team conducts targeted assessments that provide clarity, direction and measurable data to fuel your growth strategy.
- 3 Recommended Motions**
With a plan established, TD SYNEX guides partners through the execution phase with hands-on support and proven best practices.
- 4 Continued Guidance**
Success is not a one time event. TD SYNEX provides structured, ongoing support to ensure alignment, performance and continuous improvement.

Start your Cisco 360 journey today

Unlock stronger profitability, higher rebates and a more competitive Cisco practice. Connect with our experts on the [EDGE Training Team](#) to see how TD SYNEX can help support your Cisco business, learn more about the Cisco 360 Partner Program and capitalize on insights and opportunities readily available to you.

